MZUZU UNIVERSITY

MZUZU DATA SCIENCE SOCIETY

LOG

MZUNI DATA SCIENCE SOCIETY CONSTITUTION

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Article I: Name

The name of this organization shall be the **"Data Science Society"** at MZUZU UNIVERSITY.

Article II: Drive

Section1

The purposes of this organization are:

a) To provide a means whereby students interested in Data Science may associate with one another and exchange ideas relevant to their studies and occupational goals.

b) To provide a means whereby tutorial assistance will be arranged for students in modules deemed relevant to a Data Science major.

c) To provide a means whereby Data Scientist can be brought on campus for lectures and discussions of relevant developments in the discipline.

d) To provide a means whereby career opportunities may be known to club members of the society.

Section 2

The activities for which this club is formed are:

a) To hold workshops for society members which will cater to the skill-sets required to begin a career in the Data Science

b) To foster a culture of proactive problem-solving and data-driven thinking

c) To hold meetings of our membership at which time the members will become acquainted with one another's interests.

d) To maintain a corresponding relationship between the clubs' officers and representatives of the various Computer Science, Business, Consulting, Finance, Public Policy and any associated industries and inviting representatives of these organizations to appear on campus as guest speakers.

Article III: Authority

Section 1

This organization is a recognized student organization at MZUZU UNIVERSITY (MZUNI) and adheres to all campus policies as set forth in the Office Dean of Student Affairs (DOSA) Policies & Procedures.

Section 2

This organization may establish Standing Rules to govern administrative and procedural matters (such as time and location of meetings, etc.). Standing Rules shall not conflict with these bylaws. Standing Rules may be adopted, amended, or suspended by a majority vote present at an organization meeting where a quorum is present (advance notice is not required).

Section 3

The general rules of procedure proffered by the DOSA in terms of social and communal conduct shall be the parliamentary authority for this organization and shall govern in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with these bylaws and any special rules of order the organization may adopt.

Article IV: Membership

Section 1

Membership in the organization shall be open to all those enrolled at **MZUZU UNIVERSITY (MZUNI)** students who are interested in membership. There shall be specific requirements for admission to regular membership based on the Executive Council-determined needs of the society and the discipline at each admission cycle. Each regular member has equal rights and privileges.

Section 2

Eligibility for membership or appointed or elected student officer positions shall not be limited on the basis of race, religion, national origin, ethnicity, color, age, sex, gender identity, marital status, citizenship, sexual orientation, or disability. The organization shall have no rules or policies that discriminate on the basis of race, religion, national origin, ethnicity, color, age, sex, gender identity, marital status, citizenship, sexual orientation, or disability.

Section 3

This organization shall prohibit all members and officers from engaging in hazing or committing any act that injures, degrades or disgraces any fellow student.

Section 4

Members shall be required to attend at least 2 of the organization's regularly scheduled meetings per operating cycle.

Section 5

Every member of **MZUNI DATA SCIENCE SOCIETY** will be required to pay membership fee and yearly subscription fee which will be determined by the executive council in consultation with the incumbent patron therein

Article V: Executive Council

Section 1

The officers of the organization shall be the following:

- President
- Vice President
- General Secretary/Editor-in-Chief
- Vice General Secretary/Editor-in-Chief
- Treasurer
- Website Manager

Section 2

Powers and Duties of Officers:

President:

i. Should preside at most meetings of the Society and its executive board;

ii. Should be the Society's official representative;

iii. Should reserve room for meetings and any other events;

iv. Should approve membership applications with letter to students;

v. Should coordinate revenue activities;

vi. Should solicit award donations;

vii. Should coordinate general announcements;

viii. Should oversee all activities of the club;

ix. Should conduct his duties with the utmost decorum keeping in mind the image of the Society;

x. Should serve as a communicator between the student members and the faculty Dean, HOD;

xi. Should insure that a continuity file is updated for the semester (officer job descriptions with helpful information, contacts and phone numbers, etc.);

xii. Attend the inter- society meetings which are expected of all campus student society presidents; and

xiii. Attend any student officer trainings organized by the DOSA

Vice-President:

i. Should assist the President in performing presidential duties;
ii. Should perform all presidential duties in the absence of the President;
iii. Should ensure the execution of the responsibilities as listed in the constitution;
iv. Should strive to maintain harmony between the Society and all University organizations;
v. Should assist in solicitation of award donations for the Society (from alumni, sponsors etc.);
vi. Should maintain relations with professional association meetings;
vii. Should jointly plan for every officer to attend at least one meeting of a professional association related to Data Science;
viii. Should email all Society members in regards to coming meetings and events on a weekly basis; and
ix. Attend all inter-society meetings.

General Secretary/Editor-in-Chief:

i. Should be the editor of the Society newsletter, should record the minutes of all general and board meetings,
ii. Should write a newsletter article(s) on any topic of interest,
iii. Should send email to all officers after each board meeting regarding topics discussed;
iv. Should observe and record member active participation for scholarship eligibility (meeting sign-in sheet, event attendance record, etc.);
v. Should prepare current announcements for the meetings and events;
vi. Should coordinate printing of flyers, meeting announcements, and special events at least one week in advance;
vii. Should maintain the list of email accounts of members to forward meeting announcements and other relevant campus activities.

Vice General Secretary/Editor-in-Chief:

The vice General Secretary will be assist the General Secretary.

Treasurer:

- **i.** Should prepare and approve event budgets and financial statements each semester;
- **ii.** Should approve and request all funding reimbursement checks;
- **iii.** Should record and log all financial transactions;
- **iv.** Should maintain copies of all expense receipts and income evidence (check copies, cash receipts, etc.);
- **v.** Should record and deposit, in a timely manner, all money collected;
- **vi.** Should submit a budget and financial statements to be published in the first and last newsletter of the semester, respectively.

Webmaster

- i. Webmaster will responsible to manage Mzuni Data Science Society Website
- ii. Work hand in hand with the general secretary in uploading things meant for public consumption
- iii. Responsible for marketing innovative skills by members of the society.

ARTICLE VI: Elections and Term of Office

Section 1.

The first month of each academic year shall be the club organizational meeting where executive council will be elected.

Section 2.

Elections shall be held during the organizational meeting, and a majority vote of the members present at that meeting shall elect the club President and the club officer members.

Section 3

Those eligible to be in executive council must be in second year and third year of study at **MZUZU UNIVERSITY (MZUNI)**

Section 4

The executive council will serve the office serve for the length of one year.

Article VII: Meetings

Section 1

Regular meetings shall be scheduled weekly during the academic year. Special meetings may be called by the President or a majority of the Executive Council.

Section 2

Members must be given a minimum of 24 hours' notice prior to the meeting time.

Section 3

Business cannot be conducted unless a quorum of the membership is present. A quorum for this organization is defined as a majority of the voting membership.

Section 4

Voting members must be present to vote. Absentee or proxy voting is not permitted.

Section 5

In order to vote, a member must be in good standing as set forth in the Office of Student Affairs Policies & Procedures.

Section 6

Only current Data Science Society members can nominate and vote for candidates.

Article VIII Patron(s)

Section 1

The organization shall appoint an individual employed as a faculty or staff member by MZUZU UNIVERSITY to serve as the university advisor to this organization. Auxiliary staff and student assistants are not eligible to serve as advisors. The advisor shall fulfill the responsibilities specified in the policies as set forth in the Office of Student Affairs Policies & Procedures. Advisors shall serve on an academic year basis or until their successor has been selected.

Article IX: Executive Council Members

Section 1

The Executive Council shall consist of the elected/appointed officers. The members should be either Junior or seniors. Executive Council members shall not hold any other position in another society, particularly where goals and targets conflict. However, exceptions can be made:

a) The role in the other society is deemed to be a less important one and the outgoing Executive Council is convinced of the capabilities and dedication of the potential candidate.
b) The Executive Council wishes to appoint a member and the decision is reached via a simple majority.

Section 2

The Executive Council shall largely meet every other week during the academic year. Special meetings may be called by the President or most of the Executive Council. All members must be given at least 48 hours' notice of the meeting. A quorum shall consist of most of the Executive Council members.

Section 3

The Executive Council shall have general supervision of the affairs of the organization between meetings and is authorized to act when action must be taken prior to the next meeting.

Section 4

The Executive Council shall report to the membership all actions taken between meetings. Except when it is too late to do so (such as when a contract has been executed), any actions taken by the Executive Council may be rescinded or modified by the membership by a majority vote.

Section 5

The Executive Council is the sole student authority enabled to make decisions for and on behalf of the society, provided that these decisions are made in good faith.

Section 6

The Executive Council shall decide when to schedule interviews or any such selection process for any posts within the Data Science Society.

Section 7

The Executive Council shall, collectively and individually, ensure the upholding of this constitution.

Section 8

If the constitution is silent on a matter, the Executive Council must respond to any given issue based on precedent; in case no precedent is available, the Executive Council must make the decision judging the situation to the best of their ability.

Section 9

All members of the Executive Council must conduct themselves as role models for the remaining members of and must present themselves in a manner representative of the values of Data Science Society, including, but not limited to, the qualities of honesty, integrity, justice, discipline, professionalism and approachability.

Section 10

Should any member of the Executive Council be absent for a period of more than seven days on account of academic reasons, ill-health, family reasons (including, but not limited to a marriage or death in the family) or representing Data Science Society or **MZUNI** on an international forum, he/she may appoint any other member in the Executive Council, in advance, to oversee his/her duties, for the period of absence. If no such prior appointment is done, then the President may make the appointment on their behalf.

Article X: Finances

Section 1

This organization can assess the membership for special purposes. Assessments shall be determined by a quorum of the membership at a regularly scheduled meeting

Section 2

Members who have not submitted special assessments by the due date shall be considered as not being in good standing and shall be liable to lose membership privileges

Section 3

The Executive Council shall propose an annual budget to be voted upon no later than the second regular meeting of the academic year. Any unbudgeted expenditures shall be approved in advance by the membership. When financial decisions must be made between meetings, the Executive Council is authorized to approve expenditures as voted upon in quorum.

Article XI: Discipline of members

Section 1

A member of the Executive Council may be removed by either the Patron or a vote of no-confidence unanimously passed by the other members of the Executive Council, if that member partakes in any of the following:

i. Undermining this constitution;

ii. Undermining the internal working of the Data Science Society;

iii. Consistently failing to discharge his/her duties;

iv. Consistently failing to attend Executive Council meetings;

v. Failing to follow the core values of Data Science Society including, but not limited to, honesty, integrity, professionalism, discipline, meritocracy, justice and equality;

vi. Not following through any Policies laid out in the MZUNI Student Handbook including but not limited to misconduct.

Section 2

In the event of a sexual-harassment charge against a society member (also includes Executive Council member), the matter will be conveyed to the Executive Council who will forward it to the Office of Student Affairs. The Executive Council will do its best to assist the investigation.

Section 3

Once an approved decision is made in the event of a legitimate charge, the accused will be terminated/suspended from the society while keeping the Patron and DOSA in the loop regarding the decision

Section 4

The membership shall vote first on whether the member has engaged in misconduct. If by a two-thirds vote, the membership determines that misconduct has occurred, the membership shall then by a two-thirds vote, determine appropriate sanction(s). The accused member shall be immediately notified of the outcome.

Section 5

By a two-thirds vote, the membership may reinstate a member who has suspended or expelled

Article XII: Amendments

Section 1

Proposed amendments to these by laws shall be presented to the membership, in writing, one meeting prior to the meeting where the amendment will be voted upon

Section 2

Bylaw amendments require approval by two-thirds of the voting members present at a regular meeting. The amendment shall be effective immediately unless otherwise stipulated in the amendment.

Section 3

A copy of any amendments to these bylaws must be submitted to the Office of Dean of Student Affairs at MZUZU UNIVERSITY within two weeks after adoption.

Section 4

This Constitution may be amended by two-thirds vote of the Society's Executive Council for a limited number of times throughout the year. The exact number will be decided in the opening meetings in consultation with the Patron. A general rule of thumb would be no more than three amendments which may be initiated during a regular scheduled meeting of the Executive Council.